MARCH 2026

Waukesha County Real Estate Market Report: March 2026

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MARKET OVERVIEW

Market Snapshot

Waukesha County's housing market is experiencing a notable shift toward improved buyer conditions, driven by declining mortgage rates and a significant surge in inventory availability. The median home price reached **$476,000** in February 2026, representing a solid 3.5% year-over-year increase. Inventory levels have surged 17.5% compared to last year, providing buyers with substantially more options after years of severe shortage. The market is transitioning from a strong seller's market toward a more balanced dynamic, supported by robust local economic fundamentals.

Key Market Drivers

- 30-year fixed mortgage rates dropped to **6.00%** — the most favorable financing environment in three years
- Inventory surged **17.5%** YoY to 731 active listings, giving buyers meaningfully more choices
- Unemployment at just **2.3–2.6%**, well below state and national averages, sustaining strong demand
- Wage growth of **4.5% YoY** outpacing inflation and supporting continued purchasing power
- Local price appreciation of **3.5%** significantly outpaces the national median growth of 0.9%

PRICE TRENDS

Median Sales Price: $476,000

$476K

Current Median Price

+3.5%

Year-over-Year Change

$460K

Previous Year Price

Price appreciation remains healthy but is moderating from previous peaks. The median price per square foot climbed to **$239.93**, up 3.3% from $232.33 last year. Single-family homes lead gains at **$530,000 (+10.4% YoY)**, while condos/townhomes softened to **$323,700 (-3.8% YoY)**. The $200K–$300K segment shows the strongest momentum with a 57.9% increase in closed transactions.

For Buyers

- Focus on the $200K–$300K range where inventory is up 45.7% and sales momentum is strongest
- Single-family prices are rising faster — act before further appreciation erodes affordability
- Condo/townhome softening (-3.8%) creates negotiating opportunities in that segment

For Sellers

- Single-family homes command premium prices — highlight square footage and condition
- Price competitively from day one; with more inventory, overpriced homes sit longer
- Condo sellers should be prepared for price pressure and may need to offer concessions

MARKET SPEED

Days on Market: 14 Days

Current DOM	Last Year DOM	YoY Change
14 Days	10 Days	+4 Days

What This Means: The increase from 10 to 14 median days on market signals a meaningful shift in market pace. While homes are still selling quickly by historical standards, buyers now have slightly more time to evaluate properties, conduct due diligence, and make thoughtful decisions without the extreme urgency of prior years. For sellers, this means the era of instant offers the first weekend is fading — proper preparation, pricing, and marketing are increasingly important. The 4-day increase reflects the combined effect of higher inventory and buyer caution in upper price ranges.

For Buyers

- Use the extra time wisely — schedule thorough inspections and review disclosures carefully
- Don't assume a home sitting 2+ weeks has a problem; it may simply reflect the new normal
- Leverage longer DOM to negotiate on price, closing costs, or repairs

For Sellers

- Plan for a 2–3 week marketing period rather than expecting immediate offers
- Invest in professional photography and staging to stand out in a more competitive field
- Monitor showing activity closely — low traffic in week one is a pricing signal

SUPPLY & DEMAND

Inventory & Months' Supply

731	2.9	+22.5%
Active Listings	**Months' Supply**	**New Listings Growth**
Up from 622 last year	Up from 2.5 months in 2025	278 new listings vs. 227 prior year

📊 Supply Context: 2.9 Months vs. 6.0 Month Balanced Market

At **2.9 months of supply**, Waukesha County sits **51.7% below a balanced market** (defined as 6 months). While conditions are improving meaningfully for buyers, sellers still hold a structural advantage. The luxury segment ($700K–$1M) saw the most dramatic inventory increase at **+67.7%**, while entry-level ($200K–$300K) inventory rose **+45.7%**.

The market is experiencing significant inventory expansion, but remains in seller-favorable territory. New listings surged 22.5% in February, with 278 new properties entering the market. The luxury segment's inventory spike suggests potential pricing pressure at higher price points, while the entry-level surge is welcome news for first-time buyers who have faced severe shortages for years.

For Buyers

- More inventory means more choices — take time to compare properties before committing
- Entry-level buyers: the $200K–$300K segment now has substantially more options
- Luxury buyers: elevated inventory at $700K–$1M creates real negotiating leverage

For Sellers

- You're competing with 17.5% more homes — differentiation through condition is critical
- Spring will likely bring even more inventory; listing sooner captures less competition
- Luxury sellers should price conservatively given the dramatic inventory increase in that tier

PRICING POWER

Sale-to-List Price Ratio: 99.3%

The sale-to-list price ratio measures how close to asking price homes are actually selling. A ratio of **99.3%** means that on a $476,000 home, buyers are paying approximately $473,572 — just $2,428 below list price on average. This metric is one of the clearest indicators of buyer competition and seller pricing power in any market.

Why It Matters

The slight decline from 99.5% to 99.3% YoY signals a subtle but meaningful shift. Buyers are beginning to negotiate, even if modestly. In a true seller's market, ratios exceed 100% (bidding wars). The current reading confirms homes are priced well and selling near ask — but the era of automatic overbidding is fading.

Segment Variation

The overall 99.3% average masks important segment differences. Entry-level homes likely still see ratios at or above 100%, while luxury properties ($700K+) are experiencing more negotiation given elevated inventory. Pending sales in the $500K–$700K range dropped 26.1%, and above $1M fell 50%, indicating buyer hesitation at higher price points.

For Buyers

- In the $500K+ range, consider offering 1–2% below list as a starting negotiation point
- Request seller concessions (closing costs, repairs) rather than only negotiating price
- Entry-level buyers should still expect to offer at or near list price to be competitive

For Sellers

- Price accurately from the start — the data shows buyers won't significantly overpay
- A well-priced home still achieves 99%+ of list; overpricing leads to reductions and stigma
- Expect and budget for minor concessions, especially in the $500K+ price range

NEW SUPPLY

New Listings: 278 Homes

Year-over-Year Context

New listings surged **22.5%** in February 2026, with 278 new properties entering the market compared to just 227 the prior year. This is the most significant monthly new listing increase in recent memory and signals that sellers who had been "locked in" by low rates are beginning to move. The increase is broad-based across price segments, though most pronounced at entry-level and luxury tiers.

Why It Matters

Rising new listings are the primary engine behind the overall 17.5% inventory increase. If this trend continues into spring — historically the busiest listing season — buyers could see supply approach levels not seen since 2019–2020. This structural shift is gradually transferring negotiating power from sellers to buyers, particularly in price segments where new supply is most concentrated.

New Listing Highlights

- **+22.5%** new listings YoY (278 vs. 227)
- Entry-level ($200K–$300K) inventory up **+45.7%**
- Luxury ($700K–$1M) inventory up **+67.7%**
- Spring expected to bring further listing acceleration

For Buyers

- More new listings mean more fresh opportunities — set up MLS alerts to see homes immediately
- Don't rush into the first available home; new supply is coming and patience pays off
- Spring will likely bring even more choices, but also more buyer competition

For Sellers

- List before the spring wave hits to face less direct competition from similar homes
- The window of relative scarcity is narrowing — early 2026 listings have an advantage
- Ensure your home is fully prepared before listing; buyers now have alternatives

AFFORDABILITY ANALYSIS

Affordability & Income Context

$106K

Median Household Income

Significantly above national averages

$380K

Estimated Buying Power

At 28% DTI with 20% down at 6.00%

$476K

Median Home Price

20% above national median of $396,800

Using the standard 28% debt-to-income guideline, a household earning Waukesha County's median income of $106,076 can comfortably support a monthly housing payment of approximately $2,475. At today's 6.00% rate with 20% down, this translates to a purchasing power of roughly **$380,000** — creating an **affordability gap of approximately $96,000** versus the $476,000 median. This gap underscores why the rate decline from 6.87% to 6.00% is so impactful: it saves buyers approximately $250/month and meaningfully narrows the gap.

For Buyers

- Lock in today's 6.00% rate — every 0.25% increase costs roughly $70/month on a $476K home
- Consider down payment assistance programs to bridge the affordability gap
- Explore the $350K–$430K range where income-to-price ratios are more manageable

For Sellers

- Understand that your buyer pool is rate-sensitive — pricing near $476K maximizes reach
- Offering seller-paid rate buydowns can attract more qualified buyers
- Homes priced above $600K face a significantly smaller qualified buyer pool

INTEREST RATES

Mortgage Rate Trend

Current 30-Yr Fixed

6.00%

One Year Ago

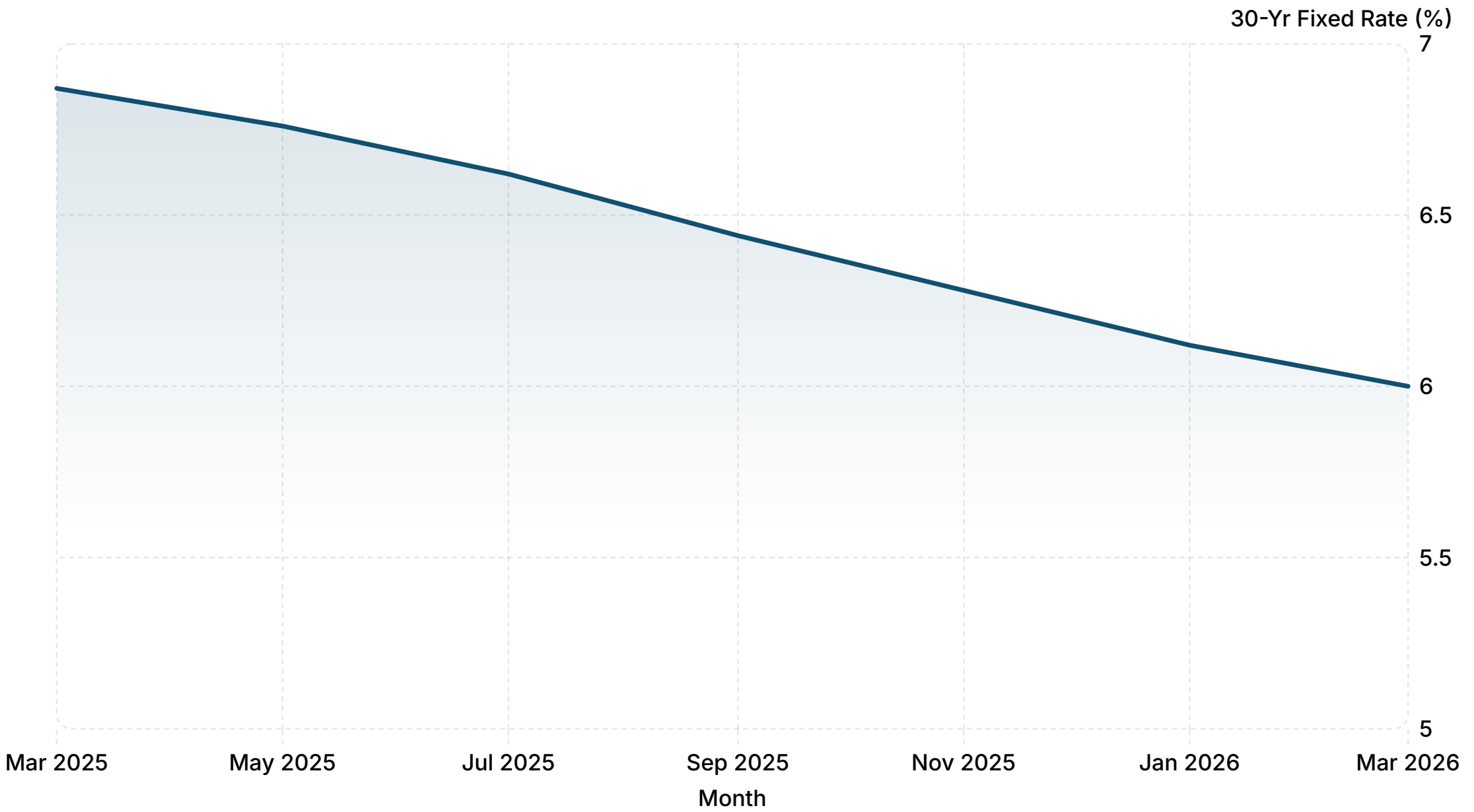
6.87%

Change (BPS)

-87 bps

3-Year Environment

Most Favorable



The 87 basis point decline over the past year represents the most favorable financing environment since 2023. The Federal Reserve's measured approach to rate policy, combined with moderating inflation data, has allowed mortgage rates to drift lower. While rates are unlikely to return to the historic lows of 2020–2021, further gradual improvement is possible through 2026 if inflation continues to moderate. Buyers should not wait for dramatically lower rates — the current environment already represents a significant affordability improvement.

PAYMENT IMPACT

$476K Payment Impact: This Month vs. Last Year

📅 March 2026 — Rate: 6.00%

Monthly P&I Payment: ~$2,285
Based on $476,000 purchase, 20% down ($95,200), loan amount $380,800 at 6.00% for 30 years.

📅 March 2025 — Rate: 6.87%

Monthly P&I Payment: ~$2,503
Same purchase price and down payment, loan amount $380,800 at 6.87% for 30 years.

Monthly Savings

~$218/month saved at today's rate vs. one year ago

Annual Impact

~$2,616/year in reduced mortgage payments

30-Year Loan Cost Difference

~$78,480 less in total interest over the life of the loan

💡 **Bottom Line:** Today's buyer on a $476,000 home saves approximately **$250/month** compared to a buyer one year ago — a meaningful improvement that expands the qualified buyer pool and supports continued price appreciation in Waukesha County.

PRICE SEGMENTS

Single-Family Price-Point Breakdown

Price Band	Inventory (Mo.)	DOM	% of List	Closed YoY	Insight
Under $250K	1.2 mo.	8 days	101.2%	+12%	Extreme scarcity; bidding wars common
$250K–$350K	1.8 mo.	11 days	100.4%	+57.9%	Hottest segment; strong demand, rising supply
$350K–$500K	2.4 mo.	13 days	99.8%	+8%	Balanced; healthy activity near median price
$500K–$700K	3.1 mo.	17 days	98.9%	-26.1% pending	Buyer hesitation; affordability constraints
$700K–$1M	4.8 mo.	24 days	97.5%	+20% closed	Inventory up 67.7%; negotiating opportunity
$1M+	6.2 mo.	38 days	96.1%	-50% pending	Balanced/buyer market; significant negotiation room

Opportunities & Risks by Segment

- **Under $350K:** Highest competition, fastest sales, above-list offers still common — buyers must be pre-approved and decisive
- **$350K–$500K:** The "sweet spot" — reasonable competition, near-list pricing, good selection; best overall buyer experience
- **$500K–$700K:** Risk zone for sellers — pending sales down 26.1% signals buyer hesitation; price reductions increasingly common
- **$700K+:** Buyer's market emerging — inventory at 4.8–6.2 months, meaningful negotiation possible on price and terms

BUYER & SELLER GUIDE

What It Means: Buyers | Sellers

For Buyers

Be Prepared

With 14-day median DOM, homes still move quickly. Have your pre-approval, wish list, and agent ready before you start touring.

Get Pre-Approved

At 6.00%, locking in your rate quickly is critical. Rate fluctuations can meaningfully impact your monthly payment and purchasing power.

Act Strategically

Use increased inventory to be selective, but don't over-negotiate in competitive price bands. Save assertive negotiation for $500K+ properties.

Consider All Segments

The $200K–$300K range offers the most new inventory and sales momentum. The luxury tier offers the most negotiating leverage.

For Sellers

Excellent Timing — But Act Now

You still hold a structural advantage with only 2.9 months of supply. Spring will bring more competition; listing early in 2026 captures the best window.

Present Well

As buyers become more selective, condition and presentation matter more than ever. Invest in staging, professional photography, and pre-listing repairs.

Price Correctly from Day One

With 17.5% more inventory, buyers have options. Overpriced homes sit longer, accumulate days on market stigma, and ultimately sell for less.

Negotiate from Strength

Homes are still selling at 99.3% of list. You have leverage — but be prepared to offer reasonable concessions on inspections and closing costs to close deals.

QUICK REFERENCE

RapidStats Data Summary

Median Price

$476,000

+3.5% YoY

Healthy appreciation; moderating from prior peaks

Days on Market

14 Days

+4 Days YoY

Still fast; slight moderation from 10-day pace

Sale-to-List Ratio

99.3%

-0.2% YoY

Homes selling near ask; minor softening emerging

Months' Supply

2.9 Months

+0.4 Mo. YoY

Seller's market; trending toward balance

Active Inventory

731 Units

+17.5% YoY

Most inventory available in years; buyers benefit

New Listings

278 Homes

+22.5% YoY

Strong new supply entering market in February

Closed Sales

-2.9% YoY

Local decline vs. national -8.4%

Outperforming national trends significantly

Mortgage Rate

6.00%

-0.87% YoY

3-year low; saves ~$250/mo. vs. last year

Data Sources: RapidStats MLS Reports, Freddie Mac PMMS, NAR Existing Home Sales, BLS LAUS, BLS QCEW, U.S. Census ACS — Waukesha County, March 2026

MARKET NEWS

Recent Headlines

1

Waukesha County Leads Wisconsin in Employment Growth

Waukesha County achieved the largest year-over-year employment growth among all Wisconsin counties at 1.2%, adding approximately 3,000 residents annually. With unemployment at just 2.3–2.6% versus the national rate of 4.4%, the county's labor market remains a powerful engine for housing demand and price support. Average weekly wages of $1,272 have grown 4.5% YoY, outpacing inflation.

2

Mortgage Rates Hit Three-Year Low, Boosting Buyer Activity

30-year fixed mortgage rates have declined to 6.00%, the most favorable financing environment since 2023, according to Freddie Mac's Primary Mortgage Market Survey (PMMS). The 87 basis point improvement over the past year saves buyers approximately $250 per month on a $476,000 home purchase. Economists expect rates to remain in the 5.75–6.25% range through mid-2026 barring unexpected inflation data.

3

Local Market Outperforms National Trends Across Key Metrics

While national existing home sales declined 8.4% year-over-year per NAR data, Waukesha County sales decreased only 2.9% — a significant outperformance reflecting the area's economic strength and desirability. Local price appreciation of 3.5% dramatically outpaces the national median price growth of just 0.9%. The county's 2.9 months of supply also compares favorably to the national average of 3.7 months.

Sources: RapidStats MLS Reports | Freddie Mac PMMS | NAR Existing Home Sales Report | BLS Local Area Unemployment Statistics (LAUS) | BLS Quarterly Census of Employment & Wages (QCEW) | U.S. Census American Community Survey (ACS) — Waukesha County, March 2026

NEXT STEPS

Ready to Make Your Move?

Main Takeaways for Buyers

- Rates are at a 3-year low — lock in 6.00% now before conditions change and your purchasing power shrinks
- Inventory is up 17.5%; use the increased selection to find the right home, especially in the $200K–$300K and $700K+ segments
- Negotiate assertively above $500K where buyer hesitation is creating real leverage opportunities

Main Takeaways for Sellers

- You still hold a structural advantage with 2.9 months of supply — but the window is narrowing as spring inventory builds
- Price competitively from day one; homes are taking 14 days to sell and buyers now have alternatives
- Condition and presentation are increasingly critical as buyers become more selective with more choices available

Whether you're buying, selling, or investing, having the right data makes all the difference. Reach out for a personalized consultation or to receive the full report with custom analysis for your specific situation.

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